



Steam controller prototype

It's only been 6 months, but things are moving fast on the Steam Controller. Check the latest version: <http://dgit.in/1nWkDLQ>



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Tablets under ₹25,000

HOW WE TESTED

The market is dominated by Android tablets in terms of variety and it makes sense because Google has vastly improved on the platform. One can easily get an Android powered tablet for as low as ₹10,000. Consumers use tablets to watch movies and videos, browse the web, play games, read ebooks, catchup with people on social networks and so on. In the corporate world, tablets are vastly used to make and show presentations and even do a bit of document editing. Photographers and graphics designers have started shifting to tablets as these portable devices offer flexibility as well as tools for editing on the go. Therefore, testing them objectively is a very important task, something that we take seriously here at Digit's Test Centre.

We have a balance of performance and design. Each tablet goes through a series of tests based on performance, specifications and the design. We see how well does the tablet perform on a day to day basis by running a series of industry standard benchmarks.

Performance Benchmarks: The performance test includes synthetic benchmarking, where we install and run apps like Quadrant, Antutu, 3DMark, GFXBench and Smartbench at uniform settings and compare scores across the category. These benchmark apps help us rate the performance potential of every device. Higher the scores, the better the tablet is supposed to perform when used for productivity and multitasking.

Battery life: Having a long lasting battery is crucial these days so another part of the performance test includes our standard battery test to find out how long each tablet would run after a

full charge. For this, we play a full HD video on each tablet after charging it to 100 per cent with the maximum display brightness. After 1 hour of playback, we determine the battery loss and calculate how long the tablet would last if we run the video continuously.

Gaming experience: Gaming is something which has gained a lot of popularity on mobile devices and tablets offer the perfect dimensions for a comfortable gaming experience. Tablets relatively have large display panels so they require a lot of power as well and the games are heavy on graphics which again stresses the GPU. We played a few games like Dead Trigger 2, Real Racing 3, Temple Run 2, Asphalt 8: Airborne and Angry Birds to see how well the GPU on the tablets can handle the high frame rates. We also focus on how smoothly the game performs and if there is any noticeable lag.

Build quality: Since a number of brands have started manufacturing tablets, the competition is stiff and to have a unique look and quality of design, OEMs are providing consumers with some really sturdy products. We have given points to each tablet taking into consideration the build quality, material used, portability, thickness and the overall experience of using each tablet. A high quality design can make a huge difference as the tablet is still considered to be a lifestyle product.

Other parameters: Apart from the above, we also tested how each tablet can handle multimedia content including HD videos in various formats, music playing capability, speaker performance, and also the camera quality. This helps us ultimately rate these devices in a fair manner.

10.1-inch 720p display there is a chunky 6000mAh battery. The UI did seem to stutter a bit although apps and games ran perfectly fine and we didn't notice any major issues. Multitasking and multimedia content was very smooth and the tablet managed to play almost every video format with ease.

Gaming experience was decent as graphic hungry games like Asphalt 8 and Dead Trigger2 were smooth. In the battery test we found that you can play a full HD video non-stop for 8 hours after a full charge to 100%.

The lowest powered tablet was the Simmtronics Xpad Turbo which comes with a

dual-core processor with a mere 512MB of RAM. Running on Android 4.2.2 the tablet was quite sluggish and at times had a slow response time. It has voice-calling facility and one can also use a SIM to gain 3G data connectivity. Basic apps and day to day productivity seemed decent, but watching full HD

videos and playing games with high-end graphics takes a toll on the hardware.

The MTV Slash 4X is a quad-core tablet which is priced at almost the same as the Simmtronics Xpad Turbo, however it is much more responsive and smoother in terms of performance. Its performance on the

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